The billion-dollar business of teaching AI

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📋 Executive Summary

Micro One reached a $1B annual run rate by hiring experts to train AI on real tasks. Businesses can also license their operational data — a potential windfall for low-margin companies without selling.

📑 Contents

- 🚀 Micro One's Billion-Dollar Model
- 💼 Beyond Coding: Expert Pay Rates
- 🏢 Licensing Business Operational Data

🚀 Micro One's Billion-Dollar Model 0:00

- Micro One is a company focused on teaching AI how to perform real-world jobs
  - They do this by working with tens of thousands of domain experts
  - Experts create training examples and review/check the AI's outputs
- Growth metrics are striking:
  - Nearly **10 million monthly visitors** to their platform
  - Recently announced surpassing a **$1 billion annual run rate**

💼 Beyond Coding: Expert Pay Rates 0:21

- Most people associate AI training work with coding, but the scope is much broader
- Example platform cited: **Merore**, which lists non-coding expert roles at competitive rates
  - Marketing experts: **$60–$70/hour**
  - Video experts: **$70–$100/hour**
  - Average contracted rate across the platform: **$93/hour**
- Merore is seeing even more traffic than Micro One — over **11 million monthly visitors**

🏢 Licensing Business Operational Data 0:44

- Micro One also licenses companies' operational data to train AI models
  - Examples of qualifying data: documented processes, support workflows, sales playbooks

    - Important caveat: the business must hold the rights to share the data, and it must meet qualification standards
- This creates a novel opportunity for existing businesses
    - The systems and documentation already built to run a business could have AI training value

      > This is described as a potential "windfall level event like an exit without actually exiting your business" — particularly relevant for low-margin businesses looking for a major upside without a sale.
- Especially relevant for businesses with low margins seeking a large, non-dilutive revenue event